

WORLD | P11
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THE VIEWS | P7
Trudeau's legacy and what lies ahead for Canada



NATION | P3
Residents reveal how owning a pet can change lives



ENTERTAINMENT | P16
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FRIDAY JANUARY 10, 2025, RAJAB 10, 1446
WEEKEND EDITION

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JIMMY CARTER HONOURED AT STATE FUNERAL

(From left, first row), US President Joe Biden, First Lady Jill Biden, Vice-President Kamala Harris, Second Gentleman Doug Emhoff; second row, former President Bill Clinton, former Secretary of State Hillary Clinton, former President George W. Bush, his wife Laura Bush, former President Barack Obama, President-elect Donald Trump and his wife Melania attend the State Funeral Service for former US President Jimmy Carter at the Washington National Cathedral in Washington, DC, yesterday.

New remote working rules for Abu Dhabi firms from April

ADGM publishes new norms for companies on hiring

DUBAI
BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

Abu Dhabi's International Financial Centre (ADGM) yesterday announced new rules for its employers to hire remote employees and to allow for more flexible working arrangements, effective April 1.

The Registration Authority (RA) of the international financial centre of Abu Dhabi – ADGM, also clarified ambiguities related to employee entitlements, including part-time employees when revising its 2019 employment regulations.

"The RA published the Employment Regulations 2024, "which reflect global changes

in workplace practices, and provide greater clarity to employers and employees with respect to their rights and obligations."

Some of the key changes in the New Employment Regulations include amending the definition of 'employee' to enable employers to hire remote employees and to allow for more flexible working arrangements; clarifying ambiguities related to employee entitlements, including part-time employees.

Some of the key changes in the New Employment Regulations include amending the definition of 'employee' to enable employers to hire remote employees.

The changes also clarify certain requirements regarding obtaining and cancelling of an employee's work permit and visa.

Commenting on the New Employment Regulations, Hamad Sayah Al Mazrouei, CEO of ADGM Registration Authority said, "We are pleased to announce the publication of the New Employment Regulations, which reflect our strong commitment to enhancing our ecosystem and ensuring the best regulatory frameworks and favourable conditions for both companies and employees alike.

"These new regulations come as we continue to expand, grow, and promote innovation in work systems. They will provide the necessary information to the business community while ensuring the protection and stability required for all parties."

Excluding fats from your diet can derail your health goals

Healthy fats help curb cravings and fuel your metabolism

DUBAI
BY LAKSHANA N. PALAT
Assistant Features Editor

Fats can significantly boost your metabolism, explain experts. Research consistently highlights the importance of incorporating healthy fats into your diet.

Fats found in foods like avocados, nuts, and olive oil, play a key role in regulating metabolism and generating a sense of satiety. A 2024 study published in *Current Developments in Nutrition* investigated the impact of daily avocado consumption on diet quality

in over 1,000 adults with obesity. Participants who added an avocado to their daily routine for 26 weeks saw notable improvements in their overall diet quality, increased vegetable intake, and a reduction in the consumption of sodium, refined grains, and added sugars.

Melanie Dsouza, Dietitian at Aster Hospital Sharjah, explains that consuming the

As fats digest more slowly than carbohydrates or proteins, they keep you feeling full for longer, preventing overeating.

right amount of healthy fats can help curb cravings and reduce the urge to snack.

Right balance

As fats digest more slowly than carbohydrates or proteins, they keep you feeling full for longer, preventing overeating.

However, without the right balance of fats, fatigue, hormone imbalances, and intense cravings for sugary or processed foods can undermine your health goals. Instead of eliminating fats altogether, the focus should be on choosing the right sources—such as avocados, nuts, and fatty fish, which has a profound impact on your wellness in the long run.

FULL REPORT ON P8-9

Army chief Aoun is Lebanon's new president

ONLY STATE SHOULD BEAR ARMS, HE SAYS, VOWING TO STRENGTHEN RULE OF LAW

BEIRUT

Lebanon lawmakers elected army chief Joseph Aoun as the country's first president in more than two years, picking a US-backed candidate in a sign of Iran's waning influence in the region.

More than two-thirds of politicians voted for Aoun to begin a six-year term, clearing a hurdle that hadn't been met in several recent failed attempts. His win ends a lengthy power vacuum and represents a pivot by Beirut toward the West, with Tehran-backed militant group Hezbollah weakened by last year's bruising conflict with Israel.

Fragile truce

Aoun, who turns 61 today, has led the army since 2017 and will be responsible for the daunting task of maintaining a fragile truce between Israel and Hezbollah while working on reforms to resolve a crippling economic crisis.

First, he must name a prime minister to help shape the nation's future after years of crises and isolation.

After being sworn in, Aoun pledged to strengthen Lebanon's rule of law and security, saying only the state should bear arms – a reference to the military powers of Hezbollah. He also said he would work to secure Lebanon's



■ Joseph Aoun

borders and focus on reconstruction and the economy.

"We are living in a crisis of governance and of rulers," Aoun said, urging lawmakers to work closely with him on what he described as difficult tasks ahead.

Aoun, the fourth consecutive military man to hold the presidency, had the backing of Washington. Optimism is running high across Lebanon as Aoun's election suggests a return to the Arab and international fold.

Fouad Makhzoumi, an MP who seeks the prime minister role, expects Saudi Arabia to strongly back a reformist government. "We will see an opening exactly the way it used to be in the nineties," he said, referring to a time marked by enormous Saudi aid to Lebanon.

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